

Sharing Tradition

- Frank Lapena

- Understanding the text

* Answer the following questions.

a. According to Lapena, what is the importance of the oral tradition? To what extent do you agree with his opinions and why?

Ans According to Lapena, oral tradition is very important because it preserves culture, values, and history. It allows people to connect with their past and maintain their identity. Through oral stories, songs, and teachings, knowledge is shared and respected. I agree with his opinions because oral tradition is not only a way to remember history but also a way to guide present and future generations. It strengthens unity and gives meaning to community life.

b. Who preserve and pass on the oral tradition?

Ans Oral tradition is preserved and passed on mainly by elders, parents, teachers, storytellers, and cultural leaders. They take responsibility for sharing myths,

legends, songs, customs, and knowledge with younger generations. Elders in particular play a vital role, as they are considered wise and experienced. By retelling stories and cultural practices, they ensure the continuation of values and traditions. Thus, oral tradition survives through living memory and the active participation of community members.

c. What is the danger of not passing on information from generation to generation?

Ans. If information is not passed on from generation to generation, there is a great danger of losing cultural values, history, and identity. Traditions, myths, and knowledge may disappear forever, leaving communities disconnected from their roots. Without oral tradition, younger generations may not understand their heritage and may adopt foreign values, causing cultural erosion. This loss weakens unity, destroys pride in one's culture, and may even result in the extinction of unique language and practices.

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d. What is the difference between oral tradition and literary tradition?

Ans. Oral tradition is spoken, performed, and remembered through storytelling, songs, rituals, and customs. It depends on memory, expression, and direct communication between people. Literary tradition, on the other hand, is written and recorded in books, scripts, or documents. It can be preserved for longer periods without relying on memory. While oral tradition is flexible and changes slightly with each telling, literary tradition is fixed and permanent. Both are valuable but use different mediums to preserve knowledge.

e. How does LaPena establish a relationship between art and the oral tradition?

Ans. LaPena establishes a relationship between art and oral tradition by showing that both are sources of inspiration and cultural expression. Just as ~~an~~ art reflects creativity, values, and heritage, oral tradition carries wisdom, history, and identity. Both require responsibility and respect for their origins. LaPena explains that oral tradition inspires artistic work and connects individuals to their culture. By honoring elders and stories, artists can create meaningful works that reflect traditions while also preserving cultural continuity.

• Reference the content

a. LaPena states that the oral tradition helps maintain the values of a culture. If you believe that the oral tradition is important, how would you maintain it?

Ans LaPena emphasizes that oral tradition is the living voice of culture. It connects the past with the present by preserving stories, songs, rituals, and wisdom. Through oral tradition, people learn about their history, beliefs, and moral values. It teaches respect for ancestors and strengthens the bond within the community. The oral tradition is passed down mainly by elders, storytellers, and cultural leaders. They use storytelling, songs, and ceremonies to transfer knowledge to the younger generation. This sharing keeps the culture alive and helps people understand their identity. Without oral tradition, a community may lose its roots, values, and sense of belonging.

To preserve oral tradition, LaPena suggests listening to elders, recording their stories, and sharing them through education and technology. Using modern media to document songs and tales can help protect them from being forgotten. Thus, oral tradition remains a vital bridge between generations & a symbol of cultural pride.

b. "Not everyone is capable of fulfilling the roles of the elders." Explain this statement with reference to the essay.

Ans. In the essay, LaPena highlights the importance of elders in maintaining oral tradition. Elders are the carriers of wisdom, experience, and cultural knowledge that cannot be easily replaced. They have lived long lives and gathered stories, songs, and lessons that younger generations may not yet understand. Their ability to guide and inspire others comes from years of practice and deep cultural responsibility.

Not everyone can fulfill the roles of elders because it requires maturity, patience, and respect from the community. Younger people may lack the wisdom or authority to teach traditions effectively. If elders are not honored, valuable knowledge may be lost forever. Thus LaPena reminds us that the role of elders is unique, and they must be supported to preserve oral tradition and cultural values for the future.

C. What is the controlling idea or thesis of this essay?

Ans. The controlling idea of LaPena's essay is that oral tradition is essential for preserving culture, values, and identity. He argues that through oral stories, songs, and teachings, a community maintains its connection to the past and ensures cultural continuity. Oral tradition is not just about telling stories; it is about honoring elders, respecting knowledge, and carrying forward the wisdom of ancestors.

Throughout the essay, LaPena emphasizes that if oral traditions are ignored, people may lose their cultural roots and sense of identity. He also shows that art, culture, and oral traditions are deeply connected, as both serve as sources of inspiration. The central thesis is clear: oral tradition must be respected, protected, and passed on to future generations for the survival of cultural heritage.

d. How do topic sentences guide the reader through the essay? What would be lost without them?

Ans. Topic sentences act like signposts in an essay. They introduce the ~~ima~~ main idea of each paragraph and guide the reader through the writer's arguments step by step. In LaPena's essay, topic sentences help to connect ideas about elders, oral tradition, culture, and art in a logical flow. This makes the ~~eo~~ essay easier to follow and understand.

Without topic sentences, the essay would lose its structure and clarity. Readers might find the ideas confusing or disconnected, and the overall message would not be clear. Topic sentences also help emphasize the writer's thesis by showing how each point supports it. Therefore, without them, the ~~story~~ essay would lack coherence, and its purpose would be weakened.

e. What are the four major ~~pr~~ problems developed by LaPena with regard to maintaining the oral tradition? How are they used to structure the essay?

Ans. LaPena develops four major problems regarding the preservation of oral tradition.

These include the loss of elders, the lack of responsibility among younger generations, the neglect of oral tradition in modern times, and the danger of forgetting cultural identity. Each of these problems shows how oral tradition is at risk if it is not valued and practiced.

He uses these problems to structure the essay by discussing them one after another, showing their causes and effects. This logical arrangement helps the reader understand the challenges clearly and recognize the urgency of protecting oral tradition. By presenting the problems in a structured way, LaPena strengthens his argument and encourages readers to respect elders and take responsibility for preserving cultural values.

- Reference beyond the text

a) Write a paragraph or two explaining your attitude toward the oral tradition of passing along information.

Ans

The Value of Oral Tradition

I deeply respect the oral tradition as

a vital way of preserving knowledge, history, and values. Before the widespread use of writing, oral tradition was the primary means through which communities shared stories, life lessons, and cultural practices. I believe it encourages strong memory, listening skills, and interpersonal connections because information is not just read - it is experienced through conversation, storytelling, and performance. Oral tradition also allows for flexibility and adaptation, letting stories evolve over generations while still retaining their core lessons. I see it as an important bridge between past and present, helping me understand where I come from and connect with the wisdom of my ancestors.

b) Our culture is our identity. Write a few paragraphs explaining how you intend to preserve your culture, values and norms.

Ans.

Preserving Our Culture, Values and Norms

Our culture is a reflection of who we are shaping our beliefs, behaviors, and

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identity. I intend to preserve my culture by actively practicing its traditions, celebrating festivals, and passing these practices to younger generations. This includes learning and sharing traditional songs, dances, and stories, as well as understanding the history behind them.

I will also uphold the values and norms that guide respectful and meaningful behavior within my community. By showing kindness, honesty and respect for elders and others, I can ensure that these principles remain alive in daily life. Additionally, I plan to document and share cultural knowledge through storytelling and social interactions so that modern influences do not dilute our traditions. Preserving culture is not just about maintaining rituals; it is about keeping the essence of our identity alive for the future.